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General Comment

As someone working in the independent publishing industry, the sudden boom in AI creation and content creates a few concerns that may cause harm not only to my particular profession, but to the wider public. The technology itself is undoubtedly impressive, but if used improperly there are a number of ways it could prove damaging to small business owners and stifle innovation.

1: Granting big tech firms or big publishers the right to peruse copyrighted material at will in order to train their models will enable them to profit off the work of smaller creators, essentially making it impossible for small business entities to adapt or grow and leaving the control of information in the hands of tech firms that may use that advantage to censor or control the flow of information as they see fit.

2: Copyright protections are vital to many creators and reward individuals for their hard work. America is vaunted for providing the opportunity for anyone to succeed given they put in the work and effort required to create a quality product. If those protections lapse, culture will be decided by a tiny number of tech firms, who will be able to suppress not only the hard work of individuals, but to sink the rise of smaller firms to challenge them. Innovation in many creative and non-creative fields will become not only difficult but nearly impossible. If America wishes to distinguish itself in the worldwide marketplace, it must allow smaller businesses and individuals to push their industries forward, and to do so they must hold some protections against the larger tech firms who would eagerly pilfer and profit from their work.

3. Big tech firms have demonstrated time and again that they will place their own interests in front of the country's when it comes to collecting data. Allowing them unfettered access to copyrighted material would allow them to sell that data not only to each other, but to foreign firms, essentially holding American work ransom for the highest bidder.

Thank you for taking the time to listen to my concerns.